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Culture (OWC): [Tonga \(FQ12\)](#)

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northeast-central Southern province, Zambia

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Cross-cousin marriage introduces some ambiguity into relationships with the children of one's father's sister's daughter. Since a man may marry their mother, they may be his children. Since they belong to the generation of his father, they are his 'mother' and 'father'. In either case marriage with them is forbidden, but the delicate problem of deciding which belongs to the senior generation still exists. Their children in turn may be classed as cross-cousins and siblings, or as grandchildren. This last, however, causes little difficulty since joking and easy familiarity pertains to all such relationships.

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Father's mother is called 'grandmother'. Her brother is usually called 'grandfather', though he is likely to be treated with familiarity since he is on the same generation level as paternal cross-cousins, who are equated with him, and he is not of the father's generation.

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Father's sister's son and father's mother's brother do not produce children who are members of the *basyanausi*. Moreover their children are not the responsibility of the generation of the *basyanausi* to which the father's son is attached. There is little to associate them together. In most cases, the Tonga do not bother to adopt kinship terms for the children of either father's

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mother's brother or father's sister's son unless some new marriage has created a new tie. If pressed, they are likely to discuss the matter in terms of potential marriages and say that since a woman may marry their father, she may call them 'child' while her brother may call them 'sister's child'. Mother's brother's children's children may be similarly classified in terms of a potential marriage, or they may become simply grandchildren since they tend to treat all members of their grandfather's matrilineal group as one. This group is not their *basyanausi*, and it has no authority over them. The generational differences within the group are therefore irrelevant to its more remote descendants.

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Father's father and mother's father are equated. Both are called 'grandfather' and respond with 'grandchild'. Neither one has any real role to play in relation to his grandchildren. When his son's children are born, a man must cede the rights of the  [57](#) *basyanausi* over these children to his son and the son's *basimukowa*. In the same way, the father of a daughter must cede his rights as *basyanausi* to the daughter's husband and his *basimukowa* who now exercise these rights over her children. Nevertheless, some relationship is thought to exist between grandfather and grandchild. The grandfathers or their matrilineal groups should receive a small token from the bridewealth of their granddaughters. Between men and women and their grandfathers, and indeed all members of the grandfathers' matrilineal groups, there exists a joking relationship comparable in many ways to that which is found between cross-cousins. It plays upon marriage and sex in a restrained fashion, without the boisterous quality which appears in the joking of cross-cousins. Marriage back into the grandfathers' matrilineal groups is considered an excellent arrangement, though marriage with the real grandfather is not permitted. No doubt the general lack of emphasis upon the importance of the grandfather and his kin is a reflection of the matrilineal character of the society. But so long as cross-cousin marriages are common, it would be difficult to assign some more specific role to the grandfather and his kin, since in many cases they are also either *basimukowa* or *basyanausi*.

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Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



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